

Acquiring peptide CDMO company (PolyPeptide) Quick Note

Samsung Biologics (SB) on 20 July announced to acquire PolyPeptide Group AG (PPGN) (PPGN SW, Not rated; market cap USD1.7bn), a peptide CDMO company. SB plans to secure a 100% stake through a tender offer, with total deal value amounting KRW2.7tn. This acquisition represents SB's strategic expansion beyond its antibody contract development and manufacturing organization (CDMO) capabilities into the peptide CDMO market. We regard SB's key strategic rationale as it could capture the rapidly growing outsourcing demand for GLP-1 peptide manufacturing.

PPGN recorded revenue of EUR236.6bn (+41.6% y-y) in 1H26 with EBITDA margin of 20.7%. The company guided for 2026E revenue growth of 25-30%y-y and high-teens EBITDA margin. Based on PPGN's record (PPGN is participating in one-third of global peptide Phase III trials) and solvent reduction technology, the company has secured contracts with many of the global top 20 big pharmas, to our knowledge.

Total deal value of KRW2.7tn, assuming 100% stake acquisition

- On 20 July, SB announced its plans to acquire 100% of PPGN at CHF44.31/share, implying an equity value of CHF1.46bn (KRW2.7tn). The acquisition will be financed through a combination of existing cash (KRW1.6tn of cash, cash & equivalent, as of 1Q26), future operating cash flow, and debt while management indicated that equity financing could be a potential option.
- Prior to the launch of the tender offer, Draupnir Holding B.V. (unlisted), PolyPeptide's controlling shareholder with 55.6% interest, irrevocably committed to tendering its entire stake. As such, SB has secured control over the majority of the shares. Completion of the transaction is conditional upon SB acquiring at least two-thirds (66.7%) of the voting rights through the tender offer. The tender offer will be launched by end-August 2026 and continue for ~2 months.

Our thoughts – capturing a share of growing GLP-1 market at 2026E EV/EBITDA of 19.1x

We view the acquisition as strategically attractive, EPS accretive, and financially reasonable. At an implied 19.1x 2026E EV/EBITDA (source: Bloomberg; peers such as Lonza [LONN SW, Not rated] and Bachem [BANB SW, Not rated] both trade at EV/EBITDA of 18.6x – both have no M&A premium), PolyPeptide offers manufacturing platform across Europe (including Sweden, Belgium, France) and the US (California) and operational synergy with SB in the following way: 1) revenue synergies include cross-selling to non-overlapping customer bases and capturing growth in the expanding GLP-1 peptide market, where PolyPeptide leads with the largest Phase III pipeline among CDMOs; 2) cost synergies emerge from enhanced purchasing power and integrating SB's automation with PolyPeptide's peptide expertise; and 3) strategic synergies transform SB from a single antibody CDMO into a diversified platform.

Global GLP-1 RAs – The bonanza would continue (link; 9 July 2026)

Glucagon-like peptide-1 receptor agonists (GLP-1 RAs) have been the poster child of global healthcare in recent years. Tirzepatide and semaglutide, the two blockbuster GLP-1 RAs, overtook pembrolizumab (a PD-1 inhibitor for the treatment of various types of cancer) in 2025 to become the global No.1 and No.2 best-selling medications, respectively, as per BioSpace data. Eli Lilly (LLY US, not rated), the company behind tirzepatide, is the first pharmaceutical company to reach a USD1tn market cap. With a current market size of USD72bn, GLP-1 RAs in total are forecast by third-party data

Rating Remains	Buy
Target price Remains	KRW 2,200,000
Closing price 16 July 2026	KRW 1,396,000

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providers (F&S) to reach USD180bn in the next 10 years – equivalent to a CAGR of c.11%. Geography expansion, from the lucrative US market (currently accounting for more than half of global sales) to rest of the world (ROW) markets that feature lower prices but a strong pool of patients, would be a major market driver, in our view.

PolyPeptide Group history

PolyPeptide Group is a leading peptide active pharmaceutical ingredient (API) CDMO, specializing in the development and commercial manufacturing of therapeutic peptides. The company serves global pharmaceutical and biotechnology companies across metabolic diseases (including GLP-1 therapies), oncology, endocrinology. PolyPeptide originated as the peptide manufacturing division of Ferring Pharmaceuticals (unlisted) in 1952. In 1996, Ferring separated the manufacturing business into an independent CDMO. PolyPeptide was listed on the SIX Swiss Exchange in 2021.

Fig. 1: PolyPeptide key financials (2023-1H26)

(EUR mn)	2023	2024	2025	1H 2026
Revenue	320.4	336.8	389.3	236.6
Operating Income	(36.5)	(7.4)	8.7	
OPM (%)	-11.4%	-2.2%	2.2%	
Net Income	(51.4)	(19.6)	(21.2)	
NPM (%)	-16%	-6%	-5%	
Total Assets	689.1	756.6	826.0	
Cash & cash equivalents	95.7	68.3	74.6	
Total Liabilities	308.0	399.3	485.4	
Interest bearing debt	114.9	104.9	141.3	
Total Equity	381.1	357.2	340.6	
ROE (%)	-12.8%	-5.3%	-6.1%	
Net debt	19.2	36.6	66.8	
Net debt/equity (%)	5.0%	10.2%	19.6%	

Source: Company data, Nomura research

Appendix A-1

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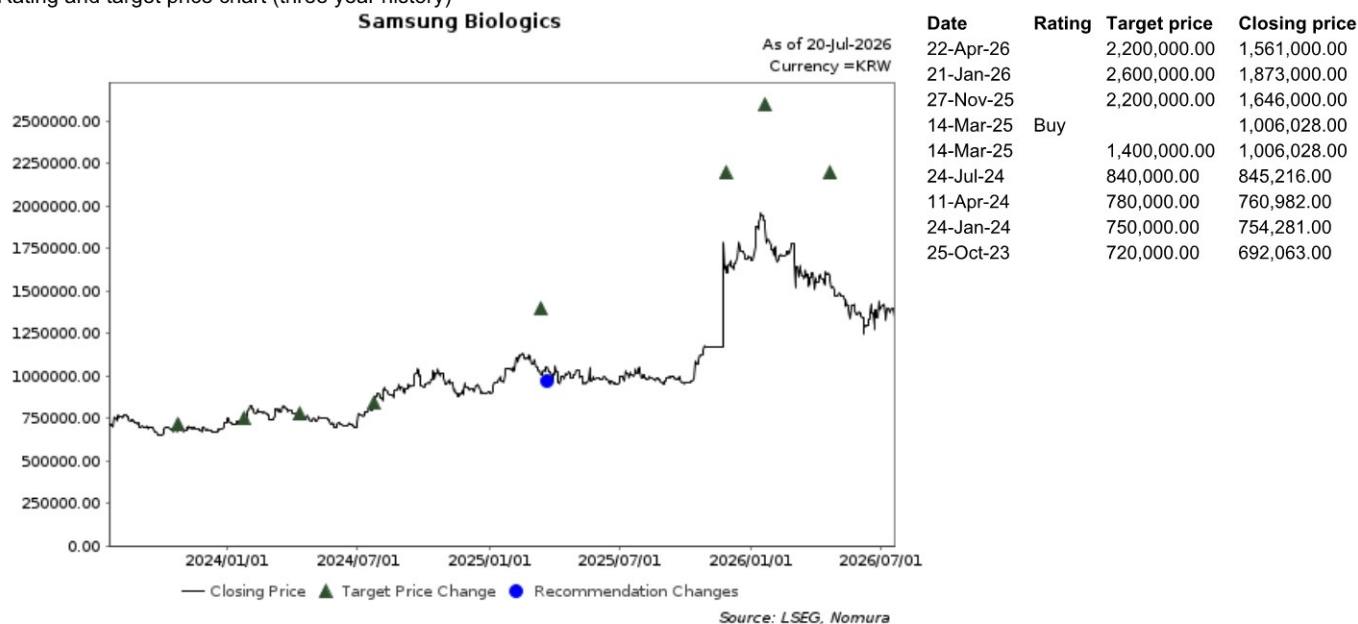
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Issuer	Ticker	Price KRW	Price date	Stock rating	Sector rating	Disclosures
Samsung Biologics	207940 KS	1,396,000	16-Jul-2026	Buy	N/A	

Samsung Biologics (207940 KS)

KRW 1,396,000 (16-Jul-2026) Buy (Sector rating: N/A)

Rating and target price chart (three year history)



For explanation of ratings refer to the stock rating keys located after chart(s)

Valuation Methodology Our target price of KRW2,200,000 is based on DCF valuation, where we value: 1) revenue from the CMO business growing at 10%p.a. during 2026-35F, 2) average OPM of 47% during 2026-35F and 3) with a WACC of 6.8% and a terminal growth rate of 3.0%. The benchmark index for the stock is KOSPI200.

Risks that may impede the achievement of the target price Downside risks include delay in plant construction.

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